



English — Cbse English Language & Literature — 80 Marks

ANSWER KEY — FOR GRADING

Subject: English | Class: Class 9

Total Marks: 80 | Time Allowed: 3h | CBSE

General Instructions:

1. The question paper has five sections: A (Reading), B (Writing), C (Grammar), D & E (Literature).
2. Sections A-C assess language skills; Sections D-E assess the prescribed textbook.
3. Attempt all sections. Internal choice is provided in the Writing section.
4. Marks for each question are indicated against it.

Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
Section A — Reading Attempt all 2 questions. Each carries 10 mark(s).		



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
1	<i>Read the passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.</i> The River Remembers The river had no name that the new town remembered, yet it had outlived every boundary drawn upon its banks. It slipped through the valley like a ribbon of liquid glass, carrying in its current the sediment of forgotten monsoons and the ash of fires no living person could name. To stand at its edge at dusk was to hear a murmur that seemed older than language itself — a low, patient voice folding over stones. For generations, fishermen had cast their nets into its green shallows, and children had learned to swim in the pool beneath the old mango grove. The river held their footprints briefly, then smoothed them away, as though it kept its memories not in permanence but in the act of flowing. When the concrete bridge replaced the wooden one, when the rice fields gave way to brick houses, the river absorbed the change without protest, though its water grew quieter, as if grieving in a tongue no one stayed long enough to understand. Now, at the bend where the herons once gathered, a drain pipe weeps grey water into the current, and the kingfishers have thinned to ghosts. Yet on certain mornings, when mist lies across the surface like a held breath, the river seems to forget the town entirely. It remembers instead the forest that once pressed close to its edges, the deer that bent to drink, the silence before the first road was ever cut. It carries that older world forward, not as a wound but as a promise — that what flows does not vanish, but waits. (i) According to paragraph 1, what does the river carry in its current? [1 mark(s)] (A) The sediment of forgotten monsoons and the ash of unnamed fires (B) The footprints of children who swam in the mango grove (C) The grey water from the drain pipe at the bend (D) The nets of fishermen from the old town Ans: A <i>Paragraph 1 explicitly states the river carries 'the sediment of forgotten monsoons and the ash of fires no living person could name' in its current.</i> (ii) The river's water growing 'quieter' after the concrete bridge replaced the wooden one suggests that the river is — [1 mark(s)] (A) pleased by the arrival of modern construction (B) silently mourning changes it cannot prevent (C) becoming shallower due to reduced rainfall (D) losing its sense of direction through the valley Ans: B <i>The phrase 'as if grieving in a tongue no one stayed long enough to understand' indicates the river's quietness is a form of silent sorrow over the changes occurring along its banks.</i> (iii) The word 'permanence' in paragraph 2 most nearly means — [1 mark(s)] (A) a moment of great speed (B) a feeling of deep sorrow	10



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	(C) a state of lasting forever (D) a sudden loud sound Ans: C <i>The passage contrasts 'permanence' with 'the act of flowing,' implying permanence refers to something fixed and enduring rather than constantly moving.</i> (iv) What literary device is used in the phrase 'the kingfishers have thinned to ghosts', and what does it convey? [1 mark(s)] Ans: Metaphor — the kingfishers are compared to ghosts to show how few remain, conveying a sense of loss and disappearance. <i>The phrase directly equates the dwindling kingfishers to ghosts, a metaphor that conveys how the birds have become so rare they seem like remnants of a vanished past.</i> (v) Why does the river seem to 'forget the town entirely' on misty mornings? [1 mark(s)] Ans: The mist hides the town's presence, allowing the river to recall the ancient forest and natural world that existed before human settlement. <i>The passage links the mist to the river's act of remembering the forest and deer instead of the town, suggesting the mist visually erases the present and reawakens the river's older memories.</i> (vi) How does the passage present the river as both a witness to change and a keeper of memory? Support your answer with one detail from the text. [2 mark(s)] Ans: The river witnesses change — bridges replacing wooden ones, rice fields becoming brick houses — yet absorbs it without protest. As a keeper of memory, it carries 'the sediment of forgotten monsoons' and remembers the forest that once pressed close to its edges, holding the older world forward as a promise rather than a wound. <i>The passage shows the river observing human-made changes silently while continuing to carry traces of the ancient natural world, fulfilling the dual role of witness and memory-keeper.</i>	



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
2	<i>Read the passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.</i> The Quiet Magic of Small Habits We often imagine that success arrives in a single dramatic moment — a sudden breakthrough, a lucky break, an overnight transformation. The truth is far less glamorous. Real, lasting change usually begins in the most ordinary way: through a small habit repeated every day. A ten-minute walk, a page of reading, a few minutes of journaling — these acts seem almost trivial when viewed individually. Yet their cumulative effect can be remarkable. Consider the simple act of reading for fifteen minutes each day. In a single sitting, the gain is modest. Over a year, however, those minutes add up to dozens of books and a broadened worldview. The habit does not transform anyone instantly; it transforms them gradually, quietly, and permanently. This is the principle of compounding: small efforts, sustained over time, produce disproportionate results. Just as a tiny seed grows into a towering tree, a modest daily practice can reshape a person's character and capabilities. What makes habits so powerful is precisely what makes them easy to underestimate. They operate below the level of conscious attention. Once a behaviour becomes automatic, it no longer requires willpower or motivation. This is why habits are both a gift and a responsibility. Good habits carry us forward even on days when enthusiasm fades, while poor ones drag us down without our noticing. The student who reviews notes each evening does not need to "feel inspired" before studying; the habit does the work. Similarly, the person who reaches for a phone first thing every morning has already shaped the tone of their day — often without deciding to. Building a positive habit does not require grand resolutions. It requires consistency, patience, and a willingness to start small. The goal is not perfection but persistence. Missing a day is not failure; abandoning the effort altogether is. Habit formation is less about intensity and more about frequency. A short, regular practice will always outlast a sporadic burst of effort followed by burnout. Ultimately, habits are the quiet architects of our lives. They shape not only what we achieve but also who we become. Every repeated action casts a vote for a particular kind of future. When we choose habits that align with our values — discipline, curiosity, kindness — we are, in a sense, choosing the person we want to be. The power of a good habit lies not in any single act but in the steady accumulation of countless small ones, each one a quiet step toward a better self. (i) According to the passage, how does real, lasting change usually begin? [1 mark(s)] (A) Through a small habit repeated every day (B) Through a sudden stroke of good fortune (C) Through an intense period of concentrated effort (D) Through a dramatic overnight transformation Ans: A	10



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	<i>The first paragraph explicitly states that real, lasting change usually begins 'through a small habit repeated every day,' contrasting it with the glamorous idea of sudden breakthroughs.</i> (ii) Why does the author describe habits as 'both a gift and a responsibility'? [1 mark(s)] (A) Because they require financial investment to maintain over time (B) Because they are taught to us by others and we must pass them on (C) Because good habits help us progress while poor ones harm us without our awareness (D) Because habits are difficult to build but very easy to break Ans: C <i>The passage explains that good habits carry us forward even when enthusiasm fades, while poor ones drag us down without our noticing — making habits both beneficial and a responsibility to manage.</i> (iii) Which of the following best captures the 'principle of compounding' as explained in the passage? [1 mark(s)] (A) Large efforts made occasionally produce better results than small daily ones (B) Only intense and continuous effort leads to meaningful personal growth (C) Habits become less effective the longer they are maintained (D) Small efforts sustained over time produce results that are surprisingly large Ans: D <i>The passage defines compounding as 'small efforts, sustained over time, produce disproportionate results,' using the seed-and-tree analogy to illustrate how modest daily practices reshape a person gradually.</i> (iv) The word 'sporadic' as used in the passage most nearly means: [1 mark(s)] (A) Regular and frequent (B) Continuous and steady (C) Occurring at irregular intervals (D) Intense and overwhelming Ans: C <i>In the passage, 'sporadic burst of effort' is contrasted with 'short, regular practice,' indicating that 'sporadic' refers to something happening at irregular or infrequent intervals.</i> (v) The word 'trivial' as used in the first paragraph means: [1 mark(s)] (A) Extremely dangerous (B) Of little importance (C) Highly beneficial (D) Impossible to measure Ans: B <i>The passage describes small daily acts as seeming 'almost trivial when viewed individually,' meaning they appear unimportant or insignificant on their own, even though their cumulative effect is remarkable.</i> (vi) According to the passage, what is more important than intensity in building a positive habit? [1 mark(s)] Ans: Frequency	



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	<i>The fourth paragraph states that 'Habit formation is less about intensity and more about frequency,' emphasising that regular repetition matters more than bursts of intense effort.</i> (vii) Why does the student who reviews notes each evening not need to 'feel inspired' before studying? [1 mark(s)] Ans: Because the habit has become automatic and does the work without requiring willpower or motivation. <i>The passage explains that once a behaviour becomes automatic, it no longer requires willpower or motivation, so the habit itself drives the student to study regardless of inspiration.</i> (viii) What is the central message of the passage about good habits? [1 mark(s)] Ans: Small daily habits, when repeated consistently, compound into significant personal change over time. <i>The entire passage argues that seemingly insignificant daily habits, through the principle of compounding, gradually reshape a person's character, achievements, and future.</i> (ix) How do habits act as 'the quiet architects of our lives'? Explain with reference to the passage. [2 mark(s)] Ans: Habits shape both what we achieve and who we become. Every repeated action casts a vote for a particular kind of future. When we choose habits aligned with values like discipline and kindness, we are choosing the person we want to be. Their power lies in the steady accumulation of countless small actions, each one a quiet step toward a better self. <i>The final paragraph describes habits as architects because they silently shape our achievements and identity; each repeated action supports a particular future, and aligning habits with values is effectively choosing the person we wish to become.</i>	
Section B — Writing Attempt 2 out of 2.		



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
3	Informal Letter You are Aarav/Ananya, a Class 9 student living at 45, Rose Garden Road, Chandigarh. Your cousin Siddharth/Sneha, who lives in Delhi, has not visited your family for over a year. Write a letter to him/her inviting him/her to spend the summer holidays with your family. In your letter you may touch upon the following cues: • A family trip to Shimla planned for the first week of June • Your grandmother's 75th birthday celebration in mid-June • How long it has been since you last met and how much everyone misses him/her Word limit: 100-150 words. <i>(Word limit: 100-150 words; Suggested time: 20 min)</i> Model Answer: 45, Rose Garden Road Chandigarh 20 May 2025 Dear Siddharth, I hope this letter finds you in great spirits! It has been so long since we last met, and I really miss the fun times we shared during Diwali. Everyone here misses you terribly. I am writing to invite you to spend the summer holidays with us in Chandigarh. We have planned a week-long trip to Shimla in the first week of June, and it would be wonderful if you could join us. The cool weather there will be a perfect escape from the heat. Also, Daadi's seventy-fifth birthday falls on the fifteenth of June, and the whole family is gathering to celebrate. She keeps asking about you and would be thrilled to see you. Do pack some warm clothes for Shimla. Let me know your travel dates soon so we can book the tickets together. Everyone here is eager to see you! Yours lovingly, Aarav • Express how long it has been since the last meeting and that the family misses the cousin • Invite the cousin to spend the summer holidays with the family in Chandigarh • Mention the planned week-long family trip to Shimla in the first week of June • Inform about grandmother's 75th birthday celebration in mid-June and that she is eager to see the cousin • Ask the cousin to share travel dates so tickets can be booked together • Format: 1 mark(s) • Content: 2 mark(s) • Organisation/Expression: 1 mark(s) • Spelling & Grammar: 1 mark(s)	5



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	OR Formal Letter You are Aarav/Diya Singhal, a Class IX student of Modern Era Public School, Lake View Road, Bhopal. The school bus on Route 14 that serves your area has become highly unreliable — it is often late and sometimes does not arrive at all. Write a formal letter to The Regional Transport Officer, Madhya Pradesh State Transport Authority, Arera Hills, Bhopal, drawing attention to this problem and suggesting solutions. In your letter, cover the following points: • Introduce yourself and state the route you travel on daily. • Describe how the bus is frequently late or absent, causing students to miss assembly and classes. • Suggest displaying a fixed timing chart at each major stop. • Propose deploying a standby backup vehicle so students are not left stranded. Word limit: 100–150 words. <i>(Word limit: 100–150 words; Suggested time: 20 min)</i> Model Answer: 42, Lake View Road Bhopal – 462001 12 May 2025 The Regional Transport Officer Madhya Pradesh State Transport Authority Arera Hills, Bhopal – 462011 Subject: Request to improve the reliability of School Bus Route 14 Sir/Madam, I am a Class IX student of Modern Era Public School, travelling daily on School Bus Route 14 from Lake View Road to our campus. Over the past month, this route has become highly unreliable. The bus frequently arrives fifteen to twenty minutes late, and on three occasions last week it failed to turn up at all, leaving several students stranded at the stop. This unpredictability causes us to miss the morning assembly and, at times, the first period. I respectfully request the authority to display a fixed timing chart at each major stop so that students and parents know the exact arrival window. Additionally, deploying a standby backup vehicle for Route 14 would ensure that a breakdown or driver shortage does not leave children waiting indefinitely. I am confident these measures will restore punctuality and safety. Thank you for considering this request.	



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	Yours faithfully, Aarav/Diya Singhal Class IX, Modern Era Public School • Introduce self as a Class IX student of Modern Era Public School travelling on Bus Route 14. • State that the bus is frequently 15-20 minutes late and on some days does not arrive at all. • Mention the impact: students miss morning assembly and the first period. • Suggest displaying a fixed timing chart at each major stop so parents and students know the arrival window. • Propose deploying a standby backup vehicle to prevent students being stranded during breakdowns or driver shortages. • Close politely, expressing confidence that the measures will restore punctuality and safety. • Format: 1 mark(s) • Content: 2 mark(s) • Organisation/Expression: 1 mark(s) • Spelling & Grammar: 1 mark(s)	



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
4	Story Writing Complete a story in 120–180 words using the opening line below. Give your story a suitable title. Opening line: <i>At the end of the dusty corridor in Grandma's old house, there was a door that was always locked.</i> <i>(Word limit: 120–180 words; Suggested time: 20 min)</i> Model Answer: The Locked Door At the end of the dusty corridor in Grandma's old house, there was a door that was always locked. Every summer I asked about it, and every summer Grandma simply smiled and said, "When you are ready, the door will open." One rainy afternoon, while Grandma napped, I wandered down the corridor. To my astonishment, the door was ajar. Heart pounding, I pushed it open. A narrow staircase spiralled downward, lit by candles I had not lit. I descended, step by cautious step, until I reached a small cellar. Inside, the walls were lined with shelves of old books, handwritten letters, and framed photographs. A wooden desk held an open journal. I read the first page: "For the grandchild who finds this room — here is our family's story, preserved with love." Tears filled my eyes. Grandma had spent years collecting these memories, waiting until I was curious enough to seek them. That evening, I sat beside her and asked her to tell me everything. Some doors remain locked not to keep us out, but to invite us in at the right moment. • The locked door is at the end of a corridor in Grandma's house and has always been locked • Grandma gives a cryptic reply whenever asked: the door will open when the narrator is ready • One rainy afternoon the narrator finds the door ajar and discovers a hidden cellar below • The cellar holds family treasures — old books, letters, photographs, and a journal addressed to the grandchild • Resolution: the narrator sits with Grandma to hear the family story; takeaway about patience and the right moment • Format: 1 mark(s) • Content: 2 mark(s) • Organisation/Expression: 1 mark(s) • Spelling & Grammar: 1 mark(s) OR Informal Letter	5



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	You are Vivaan/Vanya, a Class 9 student living at 18, Saffron Street, Pune. Your grandparents, who live in Nagpur, sent you a Kindle e-reader as a birthday gift. Write a letter to them thanking them for the gift and sharing some exciting news about a recent achievement at school. In your letter you may touch upon: • how much you love the gift and how you are using it • the exciting news you want to share (e.g., a competition result) • your plans to visit them during the holidays Word limit: 100–150 words. (Word limit: 100–150 words; Suggested time: 20 min) Model Answer: 18, Saffron Street Pune 10 March 2025 Dear Dada and Dadi, I hope you both are keeping well. I am writing to thank you from the bottom of my heart for the wonderful Kindle you sent me for my birthday. It was such a thoughtful gift! I have already downloaded several books and am enjoying reading before bedtime every night. I also wanted to share some exciting news with you. Last week, I participated in our school's inter-house science exhibition and my project on solar energy won the first prize! My science teacher praised my effort and even recommended me for the district-level competition next month. I am working hard to prepare for it. Please take good care of your health. I miss you both very much and look forward to visiting you during the summer holidays. Give my love to everyone at home. With love, Vanya • Thank grandparents sincerely for the Kindle e-reader sent as a birthday gift • Mention how the gift is being used (e.g., downloading and reading books) • Share exciting news about winning a school science exhibition • Express love and anticipation of visiting them during the summer holidays • Format: 1 mark(s) • Content: 2 mark(s) • Organisation/Expression: 1 mark(s) • Spelling & Grammar: 1 mark(s)	
Section C — Grammar Attempt all 10 questions. Each carries 1 mark(s).		



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
5	The ___ guarded his territory fiercely, while the [Nouns (Naming Words)] (A) lioness (B) lion (C) tiger (D) tigress Answer: Correct Option: (B) ► Why? The sentence pairs a masculine noun with the feminine 'lioness' and uses the masculine pronoun 'his', so the correct masculine counterpart is 'lion'. 'Lioness' would duplicate the feminine form already present, and 'tiger'/'tigress' name a different animal altogether.	1
6	If he were a better driver, he ___ the car last week. [Conditionals] (A) would not have crashed (B) would not crash (C) had not crashed (D) will not crash Answer: Correct Option: (A) ► Why? This mixed conditional has a present, ongoing condition ('If he were a better driver') with a past result ('last week'). The result clause therefore needs 'would have + past participle' — 'would not have crashed.' 'Would not crash' is present/future, 'had not crashed' is a past perfect without a modal, and 'will not crash' is a first conditional form.	1
7	The research team submitted their findings on time, ___ the review board approved them for immediate publication. [Conjunctions] (A) and (B) but (C) or (D) yet Answer: Correct Option: (A) ► Why? Both clauses express complementary, non-contrasting ideas — the submission happened and the approval followed. The coordinating conjunction 'and' correctly joins these two independent clauses of equal rank. 'But' and 'yet' imply contrast, which is absent here, and 'or' suggests an alternative, which does not fit.	1
8	The teacher suggested ___ the project in groups rather than individually. [Gap Filling] (A) to complete (B) complete (C) completing (D) completed Answer: Correct Option: (C)	1



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	► Why? The verb 'suggest' is followed by a gerund (verb + -ing), not an infinitive. Therefore 'completing' is correct. 'To complete' is an infinitive and does not follow 'suggest', 'complete' is a bare verb form which is grammatically incorrect here, and 'completed' is a past participle that does not fit the pattern 'suggested + gerund'.	
9	She has a keen interest in environmental science and sustainable development, ____ [Question Tags] (A) hasn't she (B) doesn't she (C) isn't she (D) didn't she Answer: Correct Option: (B) ► Why? Here 'has' is a main verb meaning 'possesses', not an auxiliary in a perfect tense. When 'have/has' is a main verb meaning possession, the tag uses 'do/does'. The statement is positive, so the tag is negative: 'doesn't she'. 'Hasn't she' wrongly treats 'has' as an auxiliary, 'isn't she' uses the wrong verb, and 'didn't she' uses the wrong tense.	1
10	I will give you the money ____ you promise to return it on time without any delay. [Conjunctions] (A) as if (B) so as to (C) provided that (D) rather than Answer: Correct Option: (C) ► Why? 'Provided that' is a compound conjunction introducing a condition — the money will be given only on the condition of timely return. 'As if' introduces an unreal comparison, 'so as to' expresses purpose and is followed by a verb, and 'rather than' expresses preference, none of which conveys a conditional requirement.	1
11	Each of the candidates ____ a resume along with a cover letter for the selection process. [Subject-Verb Concord] (A) submit (B) submits (C) are submitting (D) have submitted Answer: Correct Option: (B) ► Why? The indefinite pronoun 'Each' is always singular, regardless of the plural noun 'candidates' in the prepositional phrase. 'Submits' is the correct singular verb. 'Submit', 'are submitting', and 'have submitted' are all plural forms that wrongly agree with 'candidates' instead of 'Each'.	1



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
12	Scientists ___ a new species of butterfly in the Western Ghats recently. [Tenses] (A) have discovered (B) discovered (C) are discovering (D) had discovered Answer: Correct Option: (A) ► Why? The adverb 'recently' with an unspecified exact past time calls for the present perfect 'have discovered', connecting a completed past action to the present. 'Discovered' (simple past) would require a definite past time marker such as 'last month'. 'Are discovering' implies the action is still ongoing, which contradicts 'recently', and 'had discovered' requires a second past reference point.	1
13	The child talked as if he ___ a ghost. [Clauses] (A) had seen (B) sees (C) has seen (D) was seeing Answer: Correct Option: (A) ► Why? After 'as if' describing an unreal or imaginary situation in the past, the subjunctive past perfect is required. Since 'talked' is past tense and seeing a ghost is imaginary, 'had seen' correctly marks the unreal past. Present-tense forms like 'sees' and 'has seen' do not match the past frame, and 'was seeing' does not convey the unreal meaning required by 'as if'.	1
14	___ and her sister won the first prize in the group song competition at the inter-school youth festival. [Pronouns] (A) Me (B) Herself (C) She (D) Hers Answer: Correct Option: (C) ► Why? The blank requires a subject pronoun because it forms part of the compound subject of the verb 'won'. 'She' is the nominative form. 'Me' is an object pronoun, 'herself' is reflexive, and 'hers' is a possessive pronoun — none can serve as a subject.	1
Section D — Literature (Short Answer) Attempt all 10 questions. Each carries 2 mark(s).		
15	How could the poet feel his mother's presence, even though she isn't there?	2



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	Answer: The poet feels his mother's presence through his senses, which activate memories of her during everyday moments. Even though she is not physically there, certain experiences deeply remind him of her. He feels her presence auditorily when a tune of a song she used to hum while rocking his cradle hovers over his playthings. He also senses her olfactorily when the smell of shiuli flowers and the scent of the morning service in the temple come to him as the scent of his mother. Finally, he feels her presence visually when he looks into the distant sky and feels the stillness of his mother's gaze spreading all over the sky. ► Why? The question asks how the poet feels his mother's presence despite her absence. The context poem by Rabindranath Tagore reveals that the poet relies on his three senses: hearing (auditory), smell (olfactory), and sight (visual). In the first stanza, the auditory sense of a hovering tune reminds him of her. In the second, the olfactory sense of shiuli flowers and the temple service reminds him of her scent. In the third, the visual sense of looking at the distant sky makes him feel her still gaze. The answer synthesizes these three points directly from the text. [Ch 8: I Cannot Remember My Mother]	
16	What is something that the elderly in your family cannot do easily but enjoy watching you do? Answer: The elderly in my family cannot easily read and write. Like the grandmother in the text, they feel dependent and helpless because they are unable to read the alphabet or a novel on their own. Their inability to be literate makes them feel restricted. However, they enjoy watching me read and write fluently. Observing me do these things easily gives them joy and inspiration. It reinforces their belief that "for learning there is no age bar" and motivates them to seek the same independence and self-sufficiency that literacy brings. ► Why? The question asks for a reflection based on the chapter's theme. The provided context highlights the grandmother's struggle with literacy (she couldn't read the alphabet or a novel) and her desire to learn from the narrator. Therefore, based strictly on the context, the activity the elderly cannot do easily is reading and writing, and they enjoy watching the younger generation do it, which inspires them to overcome their obstacles. [Ch 1: How I Taught My Grandmother to Read]	2
17	How does the present perfect tense effectively describe the transformation of the pankha handicraft over time? Answer: The present perfect tense is used to describe actions that occurred in the past but have relevance to the current or present time, or recently completed actions. When stating that the pankha handicraft has transformed into a commercial business, this tense effectively connects the historical shift from personal use to commercialization with its present reality. It emphasizes that the transformation is a completed action whose result—the pankha being a commercial business providing livelihood—is the current, ongoing state of affairs for India's artisans today.	2



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	► Why? The answer explains the function of the present perfect tense in linking past actions to present relevance, specifically in the context of the pankha's commercial transformation. ► Step-by-step: 1. Step 1: Define the present perfect tense and its connection of past to present. 2. Step 2: Apply this definition to the specific example of pankhas transforming into a business. 3. Step 3: Conclude by explaining how the tense highlights the current reality of the craft. [Ch 5: Winds of Change]	
18	What is the poet's purpose in using the word 'music' repetitively? Answer: The poet uses the word 'music' repetitively to emphasise its vital role and constant presence in her life. The repetition highlights that music is not just a casual element but an essential therapy that she deeply relies on. Additionally, it reinforces the idea that music is a dependable friend who is always there for her. By repeating 'music', the poet shows that it is the central force that lifts her spirits, eases her ache, and gives her the strength to pull through difficult times. ► Why? The context indicates that the poet views music as a constant companion and a source of strength. The repetition of the word 'music' mirrors its continuous presence and impact on the poet. It serves to stress the ideas presented in the poem, such as music acting as 'therapy' when she feels blue, and a 'needed friend' that helps her pull through, making it the focal point of her emotional support. [Ch 12: A Friend Found in Music]	2
19	Repetition — Why might the poet have begun and ended with the same line—'I hear Bharat celebrating, the varied vocations I hear!'? Answer: The poet begins and ends with the same line to create a circular structure, emphasizing that the celebration of varied vocations is continuous and unending in Bharat. This repetition reinforces the central idea that these diverse workers form the heartbeat of the nation. By repeating the line, the poet highlights that every vocation is intrinsically linked to the country's identity. The repetition acts as a powerful refrain, bringing the reader back to the core theme: the diverse voices and vocations are what make Bharat a vibrant nation, and each one deserves equal respect and recognition. ► Why? The question targets the poetic device of repetition and its thematic significance. By framing the poem with the same line, the poet creates a cyclical effect, suggesting that the celebration of work is a constant, ongoing process in the nation. It also reinforces the poem's core message—that a nation's identity is built on the varied vocations of its people, making the beginning and ending thoughts identical to emphasize their unity and importance. ► Step-by-step: 1. Step 1: Identify the poetic device used (Repetition/Circular structure). 2. Step 2: Explain the thematic purpose (emphasizes continuous celebration and reinforces the link between vocation and national identity). [Ch 4: Gifts of Grace: Honouring Our Vocations]	2



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
20	Why do you think Khetaram has taken up this challenging job? Answer: Khetaram has taken up this challenging job out of sheer necessity and for survival. In his region, "akaal or famine is a way of life", making agriculture highly unreliable and difficult. Even in a good year, he manages to harvest only one crop of bajra, which is entirely insufficient to feed his family of five. Without this job, Khetaram clearly states that his family "would starve". Therefore, despite the severe challenges, extreme heat, and harsh conditions of the job, he continues to endure them. The job provides the essential financial support needed to keep his family from going hungry when farming fails. ► Why? The textbook context explicitly provides Khetaram's own reasoning for taking up the job. He mentions that famine is a way of life, yielding only one crop of bajra in a good year, which cannot feed his family of five, and they would starve without this job. This highlights his economic compulsion. [Ch 13: Carrier of Words]	2
21	What is the impact of the refrain, 'she's peerless, let's praise her!'? Answer: The refrain 'she's peerless, let's praise her!' has a strong impact as it reinforces the central theme of the poem—India's unmatched greatness. By repeatedly asserting that the country is peerless, the poet emphasizes that India's natural beauty, spiritual heritage, and historical greatness have no equal anywhere on earth. Furthermore, the refrain creates a chant-like rhythm that adds to the lyrical quality of the poem. It acts as a powerful, unifying conclusion to the lists of India's glories, such as the mighty Himavant, the generous Ganga, and the sacred Upanishads. Ultimately, it evokes a deep sense of admiration and pride, urging everyone to celebrate and honour this unparalleled land. ► Why? The question asks for the impact of the refrain. The context shows the refrain is a repeated assertion of India being 'peerless' (unmatched) and a call to 'praise' her. It ties together the examples of India's greatness (Himavant, Ganga, Upanishads, etc.) mentioned in the stanzas. The context also mentions the poem has a 'measured, chant-like rhythm' and a tone of 'admiration and pride', which the refrain helps to build. [Ch 2: Bharat Our Land]	2
22	A canvas is similar to a garden plot as ____. Answer: A canvas is similar to a garden plot as both serve as a space where art and life coincide. Just as a painter uses a canvas to create artwork with brushstrokes and colours, a gardener uses a plot to create nature's artwork with seeds and blossoms. The poem's line, "Each plot, a canvas wide", emphasizes this similarity. It shows that a garden plot is a medium for the gardener's creativity, much like a canvas is for a painter. Both transform a blank space into a vibrant, living masterpiece.	2



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	► Why? The poem explicitly draws this comparison in the line 'Each plot, a canvas wide, / Where art and life coincide.' By likening a plot to a canvas, the poet suggests that gardening is a form of art. A canvas provides the foundation for a painter's creation, while a garden plot provides the foundation for a gardener's creation, allowing both to bring their imaginative visions to life. [Ch 6: Canvas of Soil]	
23	Would Sentila be able to fulfil her dream of becoming a pot maker? Explain. Answer: Yes, Sentila would be able to fulfil her dream of becoming a pot maker. Despite her mother's initial refusal to teach her due to the tedious nature of the work, Sentila remained persistent and secretly approached expert potters to learn the craft. When her mother finally taught her the process, Sentila was a quick learner who carefully observed Arenla's techniques, like holding the spatula and shaping the pot's rim. Eventually, when Arenla left her to take over a session, Sentila beat the dough in perfect coordination. The story concludes with the confirmation that a new pot maker was born. ► Why? The question tests the student's understanding of the story's conclusion and Sentila's journey. The context clearly shows that despite initial hurdles (her mother's reluctance and the physical difficulty of the task), Sentila's dedication pays off. She learns the preliminary steps, observes her mother's advanced techniques, and finally succeeds when left to work independently, which is explicitly confirmed by the line 'A new pot maker was born.' ► Step-by-step: 1. Step 1: Identify Sentila's dream and the initial obstacle (her mother's refusal). 2. Step 2: Note Sentila's persistence and her status as a quick learner. 3. Step 3: Highlight how she learned by observing her mother's specific techniques. 4. Step 4: Conclude with the final outcome where she successfully takes over and the text confirms a new pot maker is born. [Ch 3: The Pot Maker]	2
24	What might be Shruti's father's reaction? Why? Answer: Shruti's father might react negatively and dismiss the idea of her participating in the fusion concert. He expresses strong disapproval of fusion music and remains adamant in his decision. He reacts this way because he firmly believes that Classical Hindustani music is the only kind of music an artist of worth should play. He considers playing the violin to Western tunes a desecration of the instrument and a betrayal of their family's traditional values. ► Why? The question asks about Shruti's father's likely reaction, which refers to his initial response when she informs him about the concert. Based on the provided text, Nabin reacts negatively and dismisses the idea. The reason for this reaction is his strict adherence to traditional Classical Hindustani music and his view that fusion music desecrates the violin and goes against family tradition. [Ch 11: Twin Melodies]	2



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
Section E — Literature (Long Answer) Attempt all 4 questions. Each carries 5 mark(s).		
25	Contrast the vocations of pot making and weaving based on Arenla's perspective. Why did she believe weaving was a better option for Sentila, and how did this influence Sentila's initial approach to learning pottery? Answer: Arenla viewed pot making and weaving as vastly different in terms of effort, environment, and economic return. Pot making was physically grueling; it required traveling sixteen kilometres to a riverbank, climbing down a sheer drop, and carrying heavy clay uphill, which caused backaches. The process of pounding stubborn clay inside bamboo cylinders was tedious, and dropping the mould meant starting over. Months of such labor yielded only a pittance. In contrast, Arenla saw weaving as a far better vocation for Sentila. Weaving was not messy like pot making and could be done indoors in all seasons. Moreover, the time spent weaving one shawl was much less, and the financial return was handsome, allowing Sentila to earn much more money while providing enough cloth for the family. Because of Arenla's strong preference for weaving and her outright refusal to teach pottery, Sentila could not openly pursue her passion at home. This influenced Sentila to keep her fascination a secret. Instead of giving up, she approached other expert potters to learn the skill, though they were initially amused by her insistence. Sentila also carefully observed her mother's techniques during pot making sessions, waiting for an opportunity to practice on her own. ► Why? The answer contrasts the physical and economic realities of pot making versus weaving from Arenla's viewpoint and explains how her opposition forced Sentila to adopt a secretive and observant approach to learning. ► Step-by-step: 1. Step 1: Introduce Arenla's perspective on pot making, highlighting the physical strain, messiness, and poor financial returns. 2. Step 2: Describe the advantages of weaving as seen by Arenla, focusing on indoor work, less time consumption, and handsome returns. 3. Step 3: Explain the direct result of Arenla's views on Sentila's life—Sentila had to hide her passion and could not learn at home. 4. Step 4: Detail how Sentila adapted by approaching expert potters and secretly observing her mother's techniques. 5. Step 5: Conclude by summarizing how Arenla's stance shaped Sentila's determination and unconventional learning path. [Ch 3: The Pot Maker]	5
26	How does Subramania Bharati employ symbolism and allusion in the poem "Bharat Our Land" to celebrate India's spiritual and philosophical legacy? Explain with specific examples.	5



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	Answer: In the poem "Bharat Our Land," Subramania Bharati masterfully employs symbolism and allusion to celebrate India's rich spiritual and philosophical heritage. The poet uses symbolism by associating natural and cultural elements with deeper meanings. The Himavant symbolises strength and permanence, emphasising the enduring nature of India's heritage. The Ganga symbolises purity and generosity, reflecting the noble qualities inherent in India's cultural identity. The Upanishads symbolise knowledge and enlightenment, representing India's intellectual and philosophical core. The "sunny golden land" symbolises richness and glory, portraying India as a land of extraordinary value. Furthermore, the poet uses allusion to deepen the poem's spiritual significance. The reference to the Upanishads alludes to ancient Indian scriptures that form the philosophical core and symbolise deep wisdom and enlightenment. The mention of Brahma-knowledge alludes to the concept of spiritual knowledge associated with self-realisation and ultimate truth, indicating that this profound wisdom has taken root in India. The reference to Buddha's dhamma alludes to Gautama Buddha's teachings of compassion, non-violence, and enlightenment, highlighting India's role in shaping major religious and philosophical traditions. Together, these literary devices elevate the poem from mere description to a powerful celebration of India's peerless spiritual and philosophical legacy, reinforcing the refrain that India is unmatched and worthy of praise. ► Why? The poet uses symbolism to give deeper meaning to India's natural and cultural features, and allusion to connect the poem to India's ancient spiritual traditions, both working together to celebrate the nation's incomparable heritage. ► Step-by-step: 1. Step 1: Introduce the poem and state that the poet uses symbolism and allusion as key literary devices to celebrate India's spiritual and philosophical legacy. 2. Step 2: Explain symbolism by discussing what the Himavant (strength and permanence), Ganga (purity and generosity), Upanishads (knowledge and enlightenment), and sunny golden land (richness and glory) represent. 3. Step 3: Explain allusion by discussing the references to the Upanishads (ancient scriptures, deep wisdom), Brahma-knowledge (self-realisation, ultimate truth), and Buddha's dhamma (compassion, non-violence, enlightenment). 4. Step 4: Analyse how these devices work together to reinforce the idea that India's spiritual and philosophical heritage is peerless. 5. Step 5: Conclude by connecting the use of symbolism and allusion to the refrain 'she's peerless, let's praise her!' and the overall impact of celebrating India's legacy. [Ch 2: Bharat Our Land]	
27	Why does the narrator initially laugh at her grandmother's determination to learn at the age of sixty-two?	5



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	Answer: The narrator initially laughs at her grandmother's determination to learn at the age of sixty-two because she finds the idea highly unusual and impractical for someone of her age. She focuses on her grandmother's physical limitations and daily responsibilities. She specifically points out that at sixty-two, her grandmother's hair is grey, her hands are wrinkled, and she wears spectacles. Furthermore, the narrator highlights that the grandmother works so much in the kitchen, leaving little time or energy for learning the alphabet. The narrator childishly makes fun of the old lady, assuming that these physical signs of aging and her heavy domestic workload make it ridiculous for her to start learning now. However, the grandmother remains undeterred by this mockery and simply smiles. She firmly believes that for a good cause, determination can overcome any obstacle, and she declares that she will work harder than anybody. The grandmother's strong conviction highlights the narrator's initial shallow assumption, proving that learning has no age bar and that willpower can conquer physical and practical limitations. ► <i>Why?</i> The narrator laughs because she judges the grandmother's capacity to learn based on her old age and physical appearance (grey hair, wrinkled hands, spectacles) as well as her busy domestic life in the kitchen. The narrator acts childishly, failing to understand the grandmother's deep desire for independence and her strong willpower, which the grandmother later proves by stating that learning has no age bar and determination can overcome any obstacle. [Ch 1: How I Taught My Grandmother to Read]	
28	The line "The voice of their vocation is the voice of their identity" carries a deep meaning about the relationship between one's work and one's self. Explain the significance of this line, discussing how different workers express their identity through their work. Answer: The line signifies that a person's vocation is not merely a means of livelihood but a profound reflection of who they are; their work gives them a unique voice and sense of self. In the poem, various workers express their identity through the distinct qualities they bring to their crafts. The craftsperson expresses their vibrant identity through fabrics woven with colours and myriad hues. The carpenters reveal their meticulous and precise nature by creating items out of wood with mathematical precision. The electricians express their purpose and identity by working with cables and wires to brighten lives. Similarly, the shoemakers affirm their identity by taking immense pride in the quality of their work, crafting footwear for feet that walk, dance, run, jump, and return home. The cook merges passion with skill, expressed through their delicious singing, while the boatmen sing while at work, telling tales of life at sea. Every worker celebrates what belongs uniquely to them and to none else. Thus, the line highlights the dignity of labour, showing that dedication to one's vocation is a direct expression of one's individuality and identity.	5



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	► Why? The question explores the central theme of the poem: the intrinsic connection between a person's vocation and their identity, emphasizing how workers inject their unique essence into their labour. ► Step-by-step: 1. Step 1: Introduce the idea that a vocation reflects a person's inner self and gives them a distinct voice in society. 2. Step 2: Explain how the craftsperson and carpenter express their identity through colours/hues and mathematical precision, respectively. 3. Step 3: Discuss the electrician's role in brightening lives and the shoemakers' pride in quality footwear for active feet returning home. 4. Step 4: Mention the cook's delicious singing and the boatmen's singing, showing how each celebrates what uniquely belongs to them. 5. Step 5: Conclude by tying these examples back to the line, affirming that one's dedication to their craft becomes their defining identity. [Ch 4: Gifts of Grace: Honouring Our Vocations]	

